

KETOTIFEN SYRUP

VIKET21-2var (MY)

DESCRIPTION

Colourless, transparent liquid with strawberry flavour.

COMPOSITION

Each 5 ml contains:
Ketotifen (as Fumarate) 1 mg/5 ml.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

Ketotifen is a histamine-H₁ receptor antagonist. It diminishes or abolishes the main actions of histamine in the body by competitive, reversible blockade of histamine receptor sites. It can also inhibit bronchoconstriction by preventing release of mediators of the allergic response including histamine and slow reacting substance of anaphylaxis (SRS-A) from mast cells.

PHARMACOKINETICS

Ketotifen is readily absorbed from the gastrointestinal tract. It undergoes hepatic metabolism and is excreted in the urine and faeces.

INDICATIONS

Ketotifen is used for the prophylactic treatment of asthma. It is also used in allergic conditions such as rhinitis and conjunctivitis.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Ketotifen should not be given to premature infants and neonates and also patients during acute attacks of asthma. Caution should be exercised when it is used in conditions such as narrow angle glaucoma, urinary retention and prostatic hypertrophy.

PRECAUTIONS

- Previous anti-asthmatic treatment should be continued for a minimum of two weeks after initiation of ketotifen treatment.
- Ketotifen may suppress positive skin test results and should be stopped several days before the test.
- Patients hypersensitive to anti-histamines may be hypersensitive to this medication also.
- It may cause dizziness, sedation, mental confusion and hypotension in geriatric patients.
- This medication may cause drowsiness. Patients affected should not drive or operate machinery.
- Patients should be warned not to take charge of vehicles or machinery.

PREGNANCY AND LACTATION

Use of Ketotifen during pregnancy is not recommended. Ketotifen is excreted in breast-milk, use by nursing mothers is not recommended.

MAIN SIDE/ADVERSE EFFECTS

- Increased appetite and weight gain
- Sedation
- Tiredness
- Gastrointestinal disturbances such as nausea, vomiting, diarrhoea or constipation

- Dry mouth
- Dizziness and headache
- Exacerbation of asthma, bronchospasm and status asthmaticus
- Paradoxical CNS stimulation may occur especially in children, with insomnia, nervousness, tachycardia, tremors and convulsions
- Allergic reactions

DRUG INTERACTIONS

- **Monoamine oxidase inhibitors**
The antimuscarinic effects of antihistamines may be enhanced if used concurrently with monoamine oxidase inhibitors and other antimuscarinic drugs such as atropine and tricyclic antidepressants.
- **CNS depressants**
Ketotifen may enhance the sedative effects of CNS depressants including alcohol, barbiturates, hypnotics, narcotic analgesics, sedatives and tranquillisers.
- **Ototoxic drugs**
Ketotifen could mask the warning signs of damage caused by ototoxic drugs such as aminoglycoside antibiotics.
- **Oral Antidiabetic Agents**
A reversible fall in platelet count may occur if used concurrently with ketotifen.

OVERDOSAGE

Clinical features

Overdosage may be fatal especially in infants and children in whom the main symptoms are CNS stimulation and antimuscarinic effects. In adults, the usual symptoms are CNS depression with drowsiness, coma and convulsions.

Treatment

- Emesis or gastric lavage, if appropriate, followed by activated charcoal.
- Supportive and symptomatic measures.
- Control convulsions by giving diazepam, 0.1 mg/kg slowly intravenously.

DOSAGE AND ADMINISTRATION

Usual adult dose:

Oral, 1 to 2 mg two times a day, with food.

Usual paediatric dose:

Below 2 years - Not established

Above 2 years - Oral, 1 mg two times a day, with food.

Storage:

Store below 30°C.

Presentation/Packing:

Syrup with strawberry flavour 100 mL, 1 L and 3.6 L.
(Not all presentation available locally)

Product Registration Holder /
Manufactured by: HOVID Bhd,
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